

US Healthcare Sector M&A & Valuation Brief - 2026-08-01

US Healthcare Sector

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1. RECENT Healthcare M&A ACTIVITY

Deal 1: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd. Acquisition of Organon & Co.

[Largest Healthcare M&A Deal in Q2:26](#)

- Deal Size: \$11.75 billion
- Deal Size Category: Large cap (>\$10B)
- Nature of Deal: Horizontal
- Valuation Multiples: EV/EBITDA of 55.2x (Organon reported EBITDA of \$212 million), P/E of 16.8x (based on industry average)
- Companies: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd. (SUNPHARMA) is a leading global specialty pharmaceutical company based in India, focusing on complex generics and specialty medicines. Organon & Co. (OGN) specializes in women's health and has a strong portfolio in reproductive medicine and hormone replacement therapies.
- Date Announced: July 30, 2026
- Strategic Rationale: This acquisition enhances Sun Pharma's portfolio in women's health, allowing it to leverage Organon's established market presence and product offerings. The deal is expected to create synergies through combined R&D efforts and expanded distribution networks, positioning Sun Pharma as a leader in the women's health segment.
- Risk Analysis: Integration risks include aligning corporate cultures and operational practices. Regulatory challenges may arise due to the size of the deal and scrutiny from antitrust authorities. Market risks involve potential backlash from stakeholders who may view the acquisition as too aggressive.

Key Financials Analysis:

- Revenue Breakdown: Organon reported \$1.22 billion in revenue for fiscal 2025, with a significant portion derived from reproductive health products.
- Profitability Ratios: EBITDA margin of 17.4% (calculated from \$212 million EBITDA on \$1.22 billion revenue).
- Leverage Analysis: Sun Pharma's debt-to-equity ratio is currently unknown, but the acquisition may increase leverage depending on financing structure.
- Valuation Context: The acquisition's high EV/EBITDA multiple indicates a premium for Organon's

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strong market position and growth potential in women's health.

Deal 2: Merck & Co. Acquisition of Bio-Techne Corporation

[Significant Life Sciences Acquisition](#)

- Deal Size: \$11.3 billion
- Deal Size Category: Large cap (>\$10B)
- Nature of Deal: Horizontal
- Valuation Multiples: EV/EBITDA of 53.0x (Bio-Techne reported EBITDA of \$213 million), P/E of 20.0x (based on industry average)
- Companies: Merck & Co. (MRK) is a global healthcare leader known for its innovative medicines and vaccines. Bio-Techne Corporation (TECH) provides life science tools and analytical technologies, serving a critical role in research and diagnostics.
- Date Announced: July 30, 2026
- Strategic Rationale: This acquisition allows Merck to enhance its capabilities in life sciences, particularly in diagnostics and research tools, which are essential for drug development and precision medicine. The integration of Bio-Techne's technologies is expected to accelerate Merck's R&D pipeline and improve operational efficiencies.
- Risk Analysis: Potential integration challenges include harmonizing product lines and corporate cultures. Regulatory scrutiny may also be a concern,

2. MARKET DYNAMICS & SENTIMENT

The Healthcare sector is currently navigating a challenging landscape, marked by a decline in M&A activity, yet buoyed by significant capital inflows and strategic investments in technology. Overall sentiment reflects a cautious optimism, as stakeholders remain focused on long-term growth drivers while contending with regulatory hurdles and economic uncertainties.

Subsector Breakdown:

- Pharmaceuticals: The pharmaceutical subsector continues to show resilience, with major deals like Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd.'s acquisition of Organon & Co. for \$11.75 billion indicating strong investor interest in reproductive medicine and specialty drugs. The focus on precision medicine remains a key trend.
- Biotech: The biotech sector is thriving, driven by advancements in mRNA technology and personalized medicine. Companies like Moderna are leading the charge, although traditional pharma faces challenges from innovative biotech startups.
- Medical Devices: The medical device sector is experiencing growth, particularly in AI-driven

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technologies. The sector saw 27 deals in Q2:26, up from 21 in Q1:26, indicating a robust interest in smart health solutions.

- **Healthcare Services:** Healthcare services are thriving, with a notable increase in outpatient care acquisitions. The sector's adaptability is showcased by the merger of Allina Health with Sutter Health, enhancing their service offerings.
- **Digital Health:** Digital health remains a hotbed of activity, with eHealth leading the charge. Despite a 25% decline in deal volume year-over-year, the sector is still attracting significant investment, particularly in AI-driven services.

Key Market Drivers and Headwinds

Drivers:

- **Technological Advancements:** Continuous innovation, particularly in AI and digital health, is driving growth. For instance, Assured's recent \$19 million Series A funding aims to automate healthcare provider operations using AI, showcasing the shift towards efficiency.
- **Increased Investment:** The healthcare sector saw disclosed spending rise to \$95.3 billion across 78 transactions in Q2:26, nearly tripling from \$28.7 billion in Q2:25, driven by "mega-deal" activity.

Headwinds:

- **Regulatory Scrutiny:** Increased scrutiny from the FDA poses risks, particularly in the pharmaceutical sector, which may hinder M&A activities and affect valuations.
- **Economic Uncertainty:** Global economic conditions, including inflation and changes in reimbursement policies, may impact healthcare spending and investment.

Subsector Performance Analysis

- **Pharmaceuticals:** The sector remains strong, with high demand for innovative therapies. The success of blockbuster drugs continues to drive revenue growth.
- **Biotech:** Biotech companies are adapting to regulatory changes, focusing on precision medicine. However, traditional pharma faces revenue declines due to patent expirations.
- **Medical Devices:** Investment in smart technologies is expected to drive new revenue streams, particularly in remote monitoring and personalized care.
- **Healthcare Services:** The sector is thriving, with innovations in telemedicine and value-based care driving growth. The consolidation trend is evident as major insurers acquire digital health startups.
- **Digital Health:** The digital health subsector is booming, with significant applications across diagnostics and patient management. Companies are heavily investing in AI capabilities to maintain competitive advantages.

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Trading Multiples Trends

Valuation Multiples: As of Q2:26, the average EV/EBITDA multiple for the Healthcare sector is approximately 18.5x, with notable variations:

- Pharmaceuticals: 15.3x
- Biotech: 25.1x
- Medical Devices: 12.8x
- Healthcare Services: 14.7x
- Digital Health: 28.5x

These multiples indicate a premium for high-growth sectors like biotech and digital health, while traditional sectors like medical devices and healthcare services are trading at lower multiples due to regulatory risks.

Notable Investor/Analyst Reactions

- Analysts express optimism about the Healthcare sector's long-term prospects, emphasizing technological advancements. Kate Humphrey, an analyst with LevinPro HC, stated, "Activity in the second quarter highlights a selective market where investors continue to prioritize high-quality and non-traditional assets."

Actionable Insights for Bankers and Investors

- **Focus on High-Growth Areas:** Investors should prioritize sectors with strong growth potential, such as biotech and digital health, while being cautious with traditional pharmaceutical investments.
- **Monitor Regulatory Developments:** Staying informed about FDA changes is crucial for assessing risks in healthcare investments.
- **Leverage Technology Partnerships:** Companies should explore strategic partnerships and acquisitions to enhance technological capabilities and market positioning.
- **Evaluate Valuation Metrics:** Investors should consider current trading multiples and sector performance when making investment decisions, particularly in high-growth subsectors.

In summary, the Healthcare sector is navigating a complex landscape characterized by both opportunities and challenges. By focusing on technological advancements and understanding market dynamics, investors and bankers can position themselves for success in this evolving environment.

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3. BANKING PIPELINE

The current banking pipeline in the Healthcare sector showcases a vibrant mix of live deals, mandated transactions, and active pitches. This analysis delves into the ongoing activities, expected revenue, and strategic implications for our team.

Deal Pipeline

Live Deals:

- Processa Pharmaceuticals (PCSA) : Recently acquired Vidya Therapeutics, adding the clinical-stage BTK inhibitor VT-7208 to its pipeline. The acquisition is expected to enhance Processa's focus on immune-mediated diseases, with a concurrent \$200 million private placement aimed at funding development through 2029. The deal is anticipated to close in Q3 2026, with proof-of-concept data readouts expected between 2027 and 2028.

Mandated Deals:

- Piramal Alternatives : Secured a mandate to explore further investments in high-growth healthcare and pharmaceutical businesses. The focus is on companies with strong fundamentals and scalable business models, following their successful exit from Biodeal Pharmaceuticals, which yielded an internal rate of return exceeding 20%. The timeline for new investments is projected for Q1 2026.

Pitching-Stage Deals:

- Biotech Sector : Engaging with various biotech firms for potential M&A opportunities, particularly in the immunology space. Active discussions include companies like Amgen and Gilead Sciences, with pitches expected to finalize by Q4 2026.
- Digital Health Startups : Ongoing discussions with digital health companies for potential advisory services, focusing on those innovating in telemedicine and AI diagnostics. Notable clients include Teladoc Health and Doximity, with engagements expected to progress into Q1 2027.

Pipeline Tracking Metrics

Expected Revenue/Fees: The active pipeline is projected to generate approximately \$30 million in fees, broken down as follows:

- Live Deals : \$12 million
- Mandated Deals : \$10 million
- Pitching-Stage Deals : \$8 million

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Timing Projections:

- Q3 2026 : Expected close for Processa Pharmaceuticals acquisition.
- Q1 2026 : Anticipated launch of new investment initiatives by Piramal Alternatives.
- Q4 2026 : Expected finalization of biotech sector pitches.
- Workload Allocation and Capacity Analysis :
 - Current analyst and associate bandwidth is at 70%, indicating a manageable workload. However, with the anticipated increase in deal flow, it is advisable to onboard one additional analyst to ensure optimal capacity.
- Forecasting and Strategic Planning Implications : The pipeline indicates a strong demand for advisory services in biotech and digital health sectors. Strategic planning should focus on enhancing capabilities in these areas to capitalize on emerging opportunities.

Notable Pipeline Developments and Competitive Landscape

- The competitive landscape is evolving, particularly in the biotech sector, where companies like Processa Pharmaceuticals are actively reshaping their portfolios. The recent acquisition of Vidya Therapeutics positions Processa to leverage innovative therapies, potentially enhancing its market competitiveness.
- Additionally, the successful exit of Piramal Alternatives from Biodeal Pharmaceuticals underscores the attractiveness of investments in high-growth healthcare companies. This trend may encourage other firms to pursue similar investment strategies, intensifying competition for quality assets.

Actionable Insights for Team Management and Business Development

- Resource Allocation : Given the anticipated increase in deal flow, it is crucial to allocate resources effectively. Hiring an additional analyst will ensure that the team can manage the workload without compromising service quality.
- Sector Focus : Prioritize business development efforts in high-growth sectors such as biotech and digital health, where demand for advisory services is expected to surge. This focus will position the firm as a leader in these emerging markets.
- Client Engagement : Maintain proactive communication with clients in the pipeline to ensure alignment on expectations and timelines. Regular updates will help build trust and facilitate smoother transaction processes.

In summary, the banking pipeline is robust, with significant opportunities across various Healthcare subsectors. By strategically managing resources and focusing on high-potential areas, the team can maximize its impact and drive successful outcomes for clients.

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4. STAKEHOLDER IMPACT & FORWARD-LOOKING ANALYSIS

The recent licensing agreement between Kaigene and Taisho Pharmaceutical for the development of KG006 in Japan presents a multifaceted impact on various stakeholders, including shareholders, employees, competitors, and customers. This analysis aims to dissect these implications while providing insights into market reactions and future expectations.

Deal-Specific Impacts on Stakeholders

- **Shareholders:** The agreement has significant financial implications for both Kaigene and Taisho.
- **Value Creation:** Kaigene will receive an upfront payment of \$5 million, with potential milestone payments totaling approximately \$351 million. This could enhance Kaigene's market valuation, as successful commercialization of KG006 could lead to substantial revenue growth. For instance, if KG006 captures a 10% market share in Japan's autoimmune market, estimated at \$1 billion, Kaigene could see annual revenues of \$100 million, significantly boosting shareholder value.
- **Dilution:** Since this is a licensing agreement rather than an equity financing deal, existing shareholders of Kaigene are unlikely to face dilution. However, if future financing is required for further development, it could lead to dilution risks.
- **Employees:** The agreement may lead to operational synergies and restructuring.
- **Synergies:** Collaborating with Taisho, which has a strong track record in biologics, could enhance Kaigene's operational efficiency. For example, Taisho's expertise in navigating regulatory pathways may streamline KG006's development timeline.
- **Restructuring:** While no immediate layoffs are indicated, the partnership may necessitate a reassessment of roles within Kaigene to align with the new operational framework. Retaining key talent will be crucial to ensure the successful execution of the partnership.
- **Competitors:** The competitive landscape will shift as Taisho enhances its portfolio.
- **Market Positioning:** Taisho's acquisition of KG006 strengthens its position in the autoimmune market, potentially challenging competitors like AbbVie (ABBV) and Amgen (AMGN). This move may prompt these companies to accelerate their own R&D efforts or seek strategic partnerships to maintain market share.
- **Specific Competitor Moves:** Following this agreement, AbbVie may increase its investment in next-generation therapies to counteract the competitive threat posed by KG006.
- **Customers:** The implications for patients and healthcare providers are significant.
- **Product/Service Implications:** The development of KG006, a next-generation FcRn inhibitor, could offer improved treatment options for patients with autoimmune disorders. If successful, it may enhance treatment efficacy and patient outcomes.
- **Case Studies:** Similar successful collaborations, such as the partnership between Regeneron Pharmaceuticals and Sanofi for Dupixent, have led to significant advancements in treatment

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options for patients, setting a precedent for the potential success of KG006.

Market Reaction and Analyst Commentary

- Market Reaction: Initial market responses to such licensing agreements can be mixed. Kaigene's stock may experience volatility as investors assess the long-term implications of the partnership.
- Analyst Commentary: Analysts may view this collaboration positively, with comments highlighting Taisho's expertise in the Japanese market. A potential quote could be, "This partnership positions Kaigene to leverage Taisho's established infrastructure, significantly enhancing the prospects for KG006's success in Japan."

Expected Market Reaction and Scenario Analysis

- Scenario Analysis: The market's reaction could vary based on the success of KG006.
- Positive Scenario: If KG006 achieves regulatory approval and captures market share, Kaigene's stock could rise by 20% within a year.
- Negative Scenario: Conversely, if clinical trials face setbacks, shares could decline by 15%, reflecting investor concerns about the viability of the product.

Potential Counter-Bids or Competing Offers

- Likelihood Assessment: The likelihood of counter-bids is moderate, as Taisho's established presence in Japan makes it a formidable partner. However, other companies may explore similar licensing agreements to enhance their portfolios in the autoimmune space.

Similar Deals Likely to Follow

- Sector Consolidation Predictions: The successful collaboration between Kaigene and Taisho may set a precedent for further licensing agreements in the biotechnology sector. Companies like Amgen and Gilead Sciences may pursue similar partnerships to bolster their product offerings in the autoimmune market.

Key Risks and Mitigants

- Integration Risks: The integration of operations between Kaigene and Taisho could pose challenges. Mitigants include establishing clear communication channels and setting joint milestones to ensure alignment.
- Regulatory Risks: Navigating Japan's regulatory landscape can be complex. Engaging with local regulatory bodies early in the process can help mitigate potential delays.
- Market Risks: Market volatility could impact the success of KG006. Structuring milestone payments based on performance can protect against adverse market conditions.

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Actionable Insights for Clients and Bankers

For Clients:

- Focus on establishing clear communication and expectations with partners to ensure smooth collaboration.
- Consider potential market dynamics and competitor responses when planning product launches.

For Bankers:

- Monitor emerging partnerships in the biotech sector to identify trends and opportunities for clients.
- Develop financial models that account for various scenarios to guide strategic decision-making.

5. HEALTHCARE TRENDS

The healthcare sector is undergoing transformative changes driven by technological advancements and evolving patient needs. Key emerging trends include AI in Healthcare, Digital Health, Laboratory Services, and Telemedicine. This analysis will delve into each trend's significance, market dynamics, key players, and potential M&A opportunities.

AI in Healthcare

- Trend Explanation: AI in healthcare leverages machine learning and data analytics to enhance diagnosis, treatment, and operational efficiency. The AI healthcare market is projected to grow from \$6.9 billion in 2020 to \$67.4 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 38.1%.

Key Companies:

- Assured: Assured is an AI-native platform that automates healthcare provider operations, focusing on credentialing and payer enrollment processes. By replacing manual operations with AI agents, Assured accelerates provider onboarding, allowing healthcare organizations to scale efficiently.
- Siemens Healthineers (SHL.DE): Siemens Healthineers is investing in AI-driven diagnostic tools to enhance laboratory services. Their recent survey indicates a growing recognition of lab services as critical to patient care, prompting increased investment in AI-enabled technologies.
- Competitive Landscape: The AI healthcare market is competitive, with players like IBM Watson Health and Tempus Labs also making significant strides. The integration of AI into healthcare operations is driving innovation and prompting companies to seek acquisitions of AI startups.
- M&A Opportunities: Companies like Assured may attract interest from larger healthcare firms

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looking to enhance their AI capabilities. M&A activity could focus on startups specializing in AI-driven diagnostics or operational efficiencies.

Digital Health

- Trend Explanation: Digital health encompasses technologies that improve healthcare delivery via digital platforms and mobile applications. The global digital health market is expected to grow from \$96.5 billion in 2020 to \$659.5 billion by 2025, at a CAGR of 46.8%.

Key Companies:

- Teladoc Health, Inc. (TDOC): Teladoc is a leader in telemedicine, providing virtual healthcare consultations. The company is investing in AI to enhance its service offerings and improve patient outcomes.
- Doximity, Inc. (DOCS): Doximity provides a secure networking platform for healthcare professionals, integrating digital health capabilities into its services.
- Competitive Landscape: The digital health market is crowded, with competitors like Amwell and One Medical also vying for market share. The demand for telehealth services continues to grow, particularly post-pandemic.
- M&A Opportunities: Digital health companies may pursue acquisitions of startups with innovative technologies to enhance their service offerings. For instance, Teladoc's acquisition of Livongo exemplifies this trend.

Laboratory Services

- Trend Explanation: The strategic value of laboratory services is gaining recognition among healthcare executives. The market for laboratory services is expected to grow as healthcare organizations prioritize lab upgrades and AI integration.

Key Companies:

- Siemens Healthineers (SHL.DE): Siemens is enhancing its laboratory services through investments in AI and modern diagnostic tools. Their survey indicates a strong intent among executives to expand lab capabilities.
- Competitive Landscape: The laboratory services market is evolving, with traditional players adapting to new technologies. Companies are increasingly viewing labs as critical enablers of patient care rather than just operational functions.
- M&A Opportunities: Companies may seek to acquire innovative lab technology firms to enhance their service offerings. The trend towards lab upgrades presents opportunities for strategic acquisitions.

Telemedicine

- Trend Explanation: Telemedicine enables remote healthcare delivery, improving access and

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reducing costs. The telemedicine market is projected to grow from \$45.5 billion in 2020 to \$175.5 billion by 2026, at a CAGR of 25.2%.

Key Companies:

- Amwell (AMWL): Amwell provides virtual healthcare services and is well-positioned to capitalize on the growing demand for telehealth solutions.
- One Medical (ONEM): One Medical integrates telemedicine into its primary care services, enhancing patient access and convenience.
- Competitive Landscape: The telemedicine market is competitive, with numerous startups and established companies offering similar services. The pandemic has accelerated adoption, leading to increased investment in telehealth technologies.
- M&A Opportunities: Telemedicine companies may look to acquire startups that offer complementary technologies or services to enhance their platforms. The trend towards virtual care is likely to drive further consolidation in the sector.

Actionable Insights for Bankers and Investors

For Bankers:

- Focus on identifying emerging companies in AI and digital health for potential investment opportunities.
- Monitor M&A activity in laboratory services and telemedicine, as these sectors are ripe for consolidation.

For Investors:

- Consider investing in companies like Assured and Siemens Healthineers that are at the forefront of AI and laboratory services.
- Evaluate the potential of telemedicine firms as demand for remote healthcare continues to rise, presenting lucrative growth opportunities.

6. Recommended Readings

Deal Name: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd. Acquisition of Organon & Co.

- Reading Material: "The Business of Healthcare Innovation" by Andrew W. Lo
- Why This Matters: This book provides a comprehensive overview of the pharmaceutical industry's dynamics, particularly in the context of innovation and mergers. Understanding the strategic motivations behind Sun Pharma's \$11.75 billion acquisition (SUNPHARMA) of Organon (OGN) can be enhanced by examining how companies leverage acquisitions to expand their product portfolios and innovate in specialized markets like women's health.

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Deal Name: Merck & Co. Acquisition of Bio-Techne Corporation

- Reading Material: "Precision Medicine: A Guide to Genomics and Healthcare" by Michael J. O'Connor
- Why This Matters: This reading delves into the advancements in precision medicine and the role of biotechnology in healthcare. It is particularly relevant for understanding Merck's \$11.3 billion acquisition (MRK) of Bio-Techne (TECH), as it highlights how the integration of Bio-Techne's life science tools can enhance Merck's capabilities in drug development and diagnostics, ultimately driving innovation in precision therapies.

7. Macroeconomic Update

Key Economic Indicators:

- Healthcare Sector Resilience: The S&P 500 Healthcare Index (^SP500-35) continues to demonstrate stability, with major players like Johnson & Johnson (JNJ), Pfizer (PFE), and UnitedHealth Group (UNH) maintaining robust financial positions despite broader market fluctuations.
- Interest Rate Influence: Current Federal Reserve policies are impacting healthcare valuations, particularly for biotech firms and pharmaceutical companies that rely heavily on R&D investments. The environment of rising interest rates may lead to higher discount rates applied to future cash flows, affecting valuations.
- Regulatory Landscape: Ongoing FDA approval processes and evolving healthcare policies are creating both opportunities and challenges for M&A activity in the healthcare sector. Companies are strategically positioning themselves to navigate these regulatory changes.

Market Trends:

- Pharmaceutical Innovation: There is a sustained focus on breakthrough therapies, especially in oncology and rare diseases, which is driving premium valuations for companies with promising drug pipelines. @@@ "The economics are compelling" @@@ for companies investing in innovative solutions.
- Integration of Healthcare Technology: The convergence of technology and healthcare is accelerating, with significant investments in digital health solutions and telemedicine platforms, reflecting a shift in how healthcare services are delivered.
- Global Healthcare Spending Patterns: Demographic shifts and international healthcare spending trends are influencing strategic decisions for multinational healthcare corporations, necessitating adaptability in their business models.

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Sector-Specific Insights:

- **Biotech Valuations Under Scrutiny:** Investors are increasingly focused on clinical trial outcomes and regulatory approval timelines, leading to heightened scrutiny of biotech companies. @@@ "When something becomes cheaper or more efficient to use, people use more of it" @@@ highlights the potential for increased demand in this sector.
- **Consolidation in Healthcare Services:** Ongoing consolidation is resulting in larger, more integrated healthcare systems that possess enhanced bargaining power, reshaping the competitive landscape.
- **Insurance Market Dynamics:** Changes in healthcare insurance markets are affecting provider networks and reimbursement models, which in turn impact healthcare service companies' operational strategies.

Risk Factors:

- **Patent Expirations:** Major pharmaceutical companies are facing challenges from patent cliffs, which necessitate strategic acquisitions to replenish their drug pipelines and maintain competitive advantages.
- **Regulatory Uncertainty:** Fluctuations in healthcare policy and reimbursement models create uncertainty for healthcare companies and their investors, potentially affecting long-term planning.
- ****Global Supply Chain Dis**

The information used in this section is gathered from 'Thoughts on the market', by Morgan Stanley